KENTUCKY COMMUNITY & TECHNICAL COLLEGE SYSTEM

ESSENTIAL SKILL 8 · FROM YOUR COLLEAGUES

Peer Review Workshop

Communication · Speech or Writing Feedback

Students review each other's draft speeches, presentations, or papers using a “3 strengths + 3 suggestions” structure, then revise their own work. A short, repeatable activity for practicing constructive feedback.

Contributed by **Sherri Basil** and adapted with permission for *Designing Collaboration That Works*, the KCTCS faculty guide to Essential Skill 8. Student-facing sections are written to copy into Blackboard. Draft for review, in-house resource.

COURSE
Any communication or writing course

LENGTH
One assignment cycle

GROUP SIZE
Pairs or small groups

FORMAT
Blackboard assignment with peer review

FINAL PRODUCT
Peer feedback forms and a revised individual assignment

Closest level in the guide: **Level 2 · Structured**

1 · Quick	**2 · Structured**	3 · Coordinated	4 · Sustained

In this packet

1. Peer Review Workshop FOR FACULTY

Peer Review Workshop

FOR FACULTY

Template alignment: Peer Review Workshop, from the Asynchronous Group Project Design Template.

Assignment Idea

Students review **draft speeches, presentations, or written assignments**.

Group Task

- Provide structured feedback (clarity, tone, audience awareness)
- Identify strengths and areas for improvement

Required Structure

- “3 strengths + 3 suggestions” rubric (explicitly recommended in template)

Final Product

- Revised individual assignment
- Peer feedback forms

Skill 8 Focus

- Constructive feedback
- Professional communication
- Respectful critique

Why It Works

This directly builds **collaborative communication behaviors** students need in workplace peer review scenarios.

Blackboard setup

Create a Blackboard assignment and turn on **Peer review** under Evaluation options. Leave the multiple-graders option (parallel grading) unchecked: Blackboard won't allow peer review while parallel grading is on.

See Blackboard's Peer Review for Qualitative Peer Assessments help for the full steps.